

THE TRUST ISSUE

How to know a hospice you can trust

Not every hospice is what it claims to be. Here is how to protect the people you love — and what to look for in care that truly honors life.

Over the last few years, California — and Los Angeles County in particular — became the center of a documented surge in hospice fraud. A 2022 report by the California State Auditor found widespread indicators of fraud among newly licensed hospices, and the state paused the issuing of new hospice licenses that same year.

We believe families deserve to understand this — not to frighten anyone, but to protect them. A trustworthy hospice is easy to recognize once you know what to look for, and the checks below take only a few minutes.

Red flags to watch for

Be cautious of any provider that recruits door-to-door or offers gifts or cash to enroll, pressures someone to sign up who is not terminally ill, cannot show a current license and Medicare certification, or is vague about who will actually visit and how to reach a nurse.

THE 60-SECOND TRUST CHECKLIST

- ✓ **Medicare certification** — ask for it, and look them up on Medicare's Care Compare.
- ✓ **State license** — a legitimate California hospice is licensed by CDPH.
- ✓ **Accreditation** — ACHC, CHAP or The Joint Commission signals outside oversight.
- ✓ **24/7 nurse access** — you should be able to reach a nurse any hour.
- ✓ **A written plan of care** — clear about who visits, how often, and what's covered.

Where we stand

Eternal Life Hospice is **Medicare-Certified, CDPH-Licensed and ACHC-Accredited**. Compliance-Led Care is one of our founding pillars — not a slogan, but the standard we hold every day. If you ever want to verify us, we welcome it.

If a hospice ever makes you uneasy, trust that instinct and ask questions. The right one will welcome them.

Questions about hospice? Talk to a nurse — any hour, any day.

Visit eternallifehospice.com →

Or call 805.953.7273 · 24/7 nurse access

MEDICARE-CERTIFIED · CDPH-LICENSED · ACHC-ACCREDITED

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Fraud references describe publicly reported findings by California state authorities (including the California State Auditor) and the state's 2022 pause on new hospice licenses. Presented for consumer education only; this does not describe or refer to any specific provider.